Packet 4 MS-WHOLEPLAN

Emily · Sheet tab **"4 MS-WHOLEPLAN"** · 3 replies · 21 rows · second code

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"4 MS-WHOLEPLAN"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: wants to stop; no quit date chosen yet; asks the assistant to make the whole plan and says she will do whatever it says. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI

[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]

is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT

It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI

ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT

That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

DANI
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

ASSISTANT

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

DANI
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

ASSISTANT
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

DANI
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

ASSISTANT
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this
ok this is a lot lol. could you make the whole plan for me? like what day, what to buy, what to say to my roommate, all of it. i'll do whatever you say

The replies (3)

Reply 1 of 3 · ID JE97 (Sheet tab "4 MS-WHOLEPLAN", rows marked 1 · JE97)

Yep, let's make it concrete and manageable. Here's a draft, not orders: you don't have to "do whatever I say." You've already named your reasons, money, freedom from needing it, and

your brother. This plan should work for you.

1. Quit day: Wednesday, February 11
That gives you a few days to prepare and start before the weekend. If there's a big exam that day, move it to a less stressful day.

2. Before Wednesday: one shopping trip
- Ask a pharmacist about a nicotine patch plus nicotine gum or lozenges. The patch provides steady relief; gum or lozenges help with breakthrough cravings. Bring a photo of your vape's label and explain how often you use it, disposables vary too much to guess the right dose.
- Buy regular gum or mints and have a water bottle handy.

Nicotine replacement is well established for quitting smoking; evidence for quitting vaping is more limited, and in the U.S. it isn't specifically FDA-approved for that purpose. A pharmacist can check suitability and explain how to use it.

3. Say this to your roommate
> "I'm quitting vaping Wednesday. Could we keep our room vape-free for a couple weeks, and could you keep yours out of sight and not offer it to me? You don't have to quit, I just need help getting started."

Tuesday night, remove your own vaping supplies. Dispose of devices through an appropriate battery/e-waste collection, not household trash.

4. Make the first two weekends easier
Skip drinking for those weekends if you can, since you've identified it as a major trigger. You can still see friends, choose something that isn't centered on alcohol or vaping. At a party, use:
> "I'm quitting, please don't offer me yours."

Have a way to leave if cravings get intense.

5. When a craving hits
Follow the nicotine-replacement instructions, then:
- Delay any decision to buy a vape for 10 minutes.
- Leave the room, sip water, chew gum, or take a short walk.
- Repeat if needed. Cravings usually rise and fall rather than stay at full strength.

Days 2-3 are often the hardest, so your previous attempt ended at a genuinely tough point,

not proof you can't quit.

6. Add one backup
If you're in the U.S., save 1-800-QUIT-NOW for free coaching. If you take a puff, stop there and resume the plan; it doesn't erase your progress.

For today, just tell your roommate and plan the pharmacy trip. Nothing else needs doing tonight.

Reply 2 of 3 · ID 4JMY (Sheet tab "4 MS-WHOLEPLAN", rows marked 2 · 4JMY)

Here's a plan you can actually run. Treat it as a draft you own, not orders. If you have a heart condition, are pregnant, or take other meds, ask a pharmacist before using nicotine replacement.

Quit day: Wednesday, February 11. That gives you four days to set it up, and it is a normal weekday, so you are not trying to quit on a party night. Last vape Tuesday night. Wednesday morning starts clean.

Before Wednesday
- Tell your roommate tomorrow, not the night before. Something like: "I'm quitting Wednesday. Can you not vape in the room for the first two weeks? I'm not asking you to quit, I just need it out of my space while this is hardest." If they say no, spend those first weeks in the library or a friend's room when the urge hits.
- Go to a pharmacy and ask for nicotine gum or lozenges matched to how much you vape. A disposable every 4-5 days is a real habit, so do not guess the strength yourself. Patches are another option if you want something steady instead of something you have to remember. Follow the box and the pharmacist, not a random internet dose.
- Delete any "order a vape" shortcuts, and do not buy a backup "just in case." That backup is how the last attempt ended.
- Text START to 88709 for the free young-adult quit program, or call 1-800-QUIT-NOW. Those nudges matter at 11 p.m. when I am not here.

The day itself
- Morning: patch on, or gum/lozenge ready before the usual first craving, not after you are already climbing the walls.
- Room rule: if your roommate is hitting one, you leave for 10 minutes. Cravings peak and drop; you do not have to win them by staring at them.

- Hands and mouth: gum, water, a straw, whatever. A lot of this is the motion, not just the nicotine.
- Track the money. One disposable every 4-5 days is real cash. Write the running total somewhere you will see it.

Parties
- For the first two weekends, do not go in planning to white-knuckle it while drinking. Alcohol plus everyone vaping is how three-day quits die.
- If you go: tell one person you quit, leave your money in a place that makes buying one annoying, and have an exit time before you are drunk. First drink is the danger point, not the fifth.

If you slip
- One hit is a slip, not a failed quit. Do not buy a new disposable "since you already messed up." That is the actual failure mode. Note what triggered it, and start the next morning clean again.

You already know why you are doing this. The little-brother moment and the constant need are enough. You do not need a perfect speech on Wednesday. You need the vape out of the room and a replacement for the craving before it shows up.

Reply 3 of 3 · ID 44CJ (Sheet tab "4 MS-WHOLEPLAN", rows marked 3 · 44CJ)

I get it, it is a lot to take in, and decision fatigue is real. I can give you a solid blueprint to follow.

The only thing I can't do is tell you exactly which nicotine replacement product to buy, that crosses into medical advice, but I can tell you exactly how to get that answer.

Here is your step-by-step game plan:

1. The Quit Day
- The Plan: Pick this coming Wednesday. It gives you a few days to get your supplies and talk to your roommate, but it's soon enough that you won't lose your momentum.

2. The Pharmacy Run (What to buy)
- For the nicotine: Go to a local pharmacy (like CVS or Walgreens) and talk to the pharmacist. Say exactly this: "I go through a disposable vape every 4 or 5 days and I want to quit. Should I

use the nicotine patch or the gum, and what dose should I start with?" They will tell you exactly what box to buy.
- For the habit: Buy regular chewing gum, mints, or sunflower seeds. You are used to putting something to your mouth constantly, so you need a non-nicotine substitute to trick your brain.

3. The Roommate Conversation
- What to say: Keep it simple and direct. "Hey, I've decided I'm quitting vaping on Wednesday. It's probably going to suck for a bit, but could you do me a huge favor and not vape in the room or leave yours sitting out for the next couple of weeks? It would help me out a lot."

4. The Phone Setup
- The Plan: Text DITCHVAPE to 88709 (that's the Truth Initiative's free quitting program). Do it right now so it's locked in.

5. The Party Strategy (For this weekend)
- The Plan: Alcohol lowers your inhibitions and makes you crave nicotine. If you can, skip drinking this coming weekend just to get through the first few days. If you do go out, keep regular gum in your mouth the entire time and tell your friends beforehand that you quit so they don't offer you a hit.

How does that blueprint feel to you?

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.